AI VS AI

Calif, Wiz and OpenAI used AI to hunt PHP bugs

AI spotted a bug humans missed for 14 years.

Attackers have the same AI. Here's how the hunt works.

Swipe →

Subhadeep Ghorai

Why you should care

Bug-hunting just got faster. For everyone.

“Tools now find bugs faster than ever, for defenders and attackers alike.” (PHP Foundation)

DOCUMENTED

Subhadeep Ghorai

Al Jazeera, 22 Oct 2026

The race

Aug

Calif finds a version using GPT-5.6 Sol

Sept

OpenAI finds the full bug; Wiz finds it too

17 Oct

A honeypot logs an early attack attempt

21 Oct

Patch ships a day early after a leak

DOCUMENTED

Decrypt, Help Net Security, BleepingComputer

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The idea

Proofreading a 1,000-page book.

A human skims. An AI reads every line, every night, and asks “what if?” at each one.

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How AI hunts · 1

Read the code

↓

Flag risky spots

↓

Throw weird inputs
called fuzzing

↓

Watch for crashes

Simplified view of AI-assisted bug finding.

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OUR BUILD

How AI hunts · 2

Humans confirm it

↓

Report privately
to PHP's team

↓

Fix built quietly

↓

Everyone patches

Wiz: frontier AI “substantially reduced” the barrier to exploiting it.

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Help Net Security

A fuzzer, in 6 lines

```
// throw random inputs, catch the crash
for (let i = 0; i < 10000; i++) {
  const input = randomText();
  try { parseAge(input); }
  catch (e) { console.log("Crash on:",
input); break; }
}
```

AI tools do this far smarter, at huge scale.

What it means for you

- ✔ **Update dependencies weekly: npm audit, Dependabot.**
- ✔ **Learn testing and fuzzing. It's a job skill now.**
- ✔ **Never ignore a security update.**

Decoder card

AI made bug-hunting faster. The winners are the ones who patch first.

Should AI labs hunt for bugs in everyone's open-source code?

NEXT WEEK · A NEW STORY, DECODED →

Subhadeep Ghorai